Metals Market Index MMI

MMi Dashboard

Iron Ore Price Indices

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI62 62% Fe Fines RMB/t

936
5 0.54%
Mar 3rd, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI65 65% Fe Fines RMB/t

1047
5.00 0.48%
Mar 3rd, 2023

Iron Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPI58 58% Fe Fines RMB/t

841
9 1.08%
Mar 3rd, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI62 62% Fe Fines USD/dmt

128.00
-0.45 -0.35%
Mar 3rd, 2023

Iron Ore Seaborne (CFR Qingdao)
IOSI65 65% Fe Fines USD/dmt

143.15
-0.05 -0.03%
Mar 3rd, 2023

Iron Ore Port Stock (FOT Qingdao)
IOPLI 62.5% Fe Lump RMB/t

1020
10 0.99%
Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023

Exchange Traded Contracts

DCE Iron Ore 62% Fines
I2305 (Jan) RMB/t (3pm close)

919.00
6.50 0.71%
Mar 3rd, 2023 (3pm close)

SGX Iron Ore (CFR Qingdao) 62% Fe Fines
March 23 USD/dmt

126.15
-0.30 -0.24%
Mar 3rd, 2023 (5.30 pm Print)

SHFE Rebar
RB2305 (Jan) RMB/t

4272
47 1.11%
Mar 3rd, 2023 (3pm close)

Freight Rates

C3, Tubarao - Qingdao USD/t

18.12
0.30 1.67%
Mar 2nd, 2023

C5, W. Australia - Qingdao USD/t

7.38
-0.08 -1.01%
Mar 2nd, 2023

Steel Price

Steel Rebar (China Domestic) RMB/t

4310
50 1.17%
Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023

Inventory Levels

Iron Ore Inventory at Chinese Ports (35)
million tonnes

136.26
-1.85 -1.34%
Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023

Steel Inventory in China
million tonnes

19.65
0.17 0.88%
Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023

Steel Price

Steel HRC (China Domestic) RMB/t

4340
40 0.93%
Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023

IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX (IOPI)

Mar 3rd, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	936	5	0.5%	869	880	858	892	126.37	0.12	0.1%	120.06	120.58	117.93	122.93
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	841	9	1.1%	813	798	761	793	114.39	0.75	0.7%	113.29	110.17	105.29	110.04
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	1047	5	0.5%	981	992	970	1003	141.82	0.05	0.0%	136.05	136.43	133.84	138.73

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX (IOSI)

Mar 3rd, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	Price	Change	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	128.00	-0.45	-0.35%	108.59	122.52	83.90	159.45
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	143.15	-0.05	-0.03%	119.09	139.52	94.45	185.82

MARKET COMMENTARY

DCE iron ore futures continued to fluctuate rose in a day, the main contract closed 919, an increase of 1.04% throughout the day. some traders quotation is still stronger; Some steel procurement more cautious, the continuation of a small number of multi-frequency procurement strategy. PBF at Shandong port dealt 920-925 yuan/mt; increased 3-10 yuan/mt over yesterday. PBF at Tangshan port dealt 935 yuan/mt; the same as yesterday. increased 5 yuan/mt over yesterday.The inventory of 35 ports tracked by SMM totaled 136.26 million tons, down 1.85 million tons from last week and 13.81 million tons from the same period last year. The average daily port dredging volume of imported mines in this period increased by 16000 tons to 3.089 million tons on a weekly basis, and the port dredging volume increased for five consecutive periods, and is now returning to a relatively high level. In the future, the supply is relatively stable, but the output of blast furnace molten iron is still expected to rise, the end demand of steel is improved, and the ore price may continue to be strong and volatile in the short term due to the expected preference during major conferences.

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX (IOPLI)

Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [3]						
Index	Fe Content	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]	Price	W-o-W	Change %	MTD	YTD	Low [2]	High [2]
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	1020	10	1.0%	907	1035	770	1405	131.99	0.46	0.35%	116.80	138.64	94.72	199.13

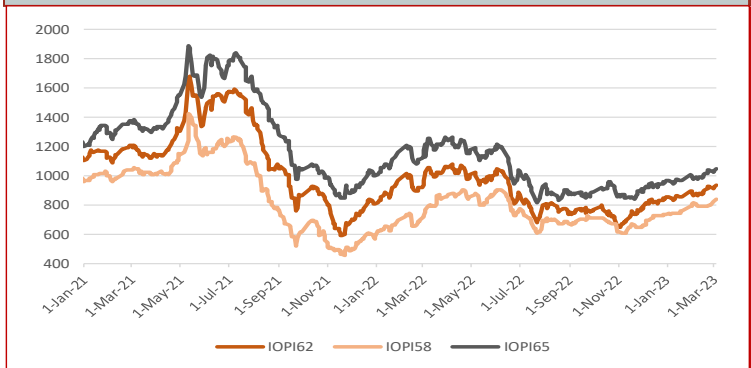
IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE SPOT PRICE ASSESSMENTS AND COMPOSITE INDEX

Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023				RMB/tonne (excluding tax) [3]				USD/tonne (excluding tax) [3]			
Province	Region	Product	Basis	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Hebei	Hanxing	66% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1087	4.2%	779	1645	156.89	3.47%	110.31	255.69
Hebei	Qian'an	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1085	0.9%	780	1630	156.60	0.21%	110.51	251.57
Liaoning	Anshan	65% Fe Concentrate	Wet	815	0.6%	620	1310	117.63	-0.11%	87.40	202.32
Shandong	Zibo	65% Fe Concentrate	Dry	1110	4.1%	800	1752	160.21	3.38%	117.19	272.32

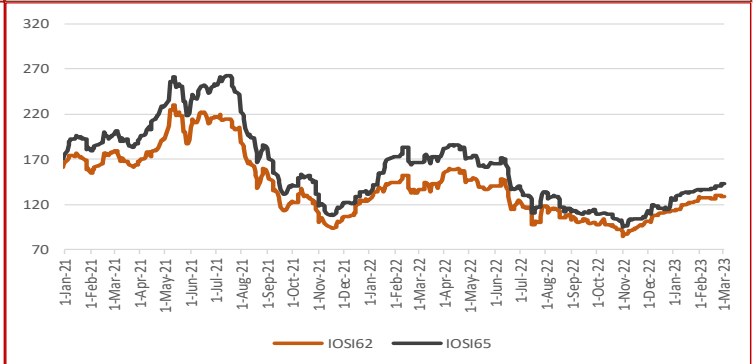
Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
China Mines Concentrate Composite Index RMB/WT	969.18	2.06%	706.36	1511.22

[1] Exchange rate applied: RMB/USD = 6.7522 [2] Last 12 months
[3] Weekly exchange rate applied: RMB/USD =6.92832

IRON ORE PORT INDEX, FOT QINGDAO (RMB/WT)



IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX, CFR QINGDAO (USD/DMT)



IRON ORE PORT STOCK INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 3rd, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPI62	62% Fe Fines	714	822	856	892	869	881	880	92.18	109.43	117.00	121.64	120.06	120.90	120.58
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	635	711	751	799	813	792	798	82.39	95.17	103.34	109.79	113.29	109.35	110.17
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	865	935	968	1003	981	993	992	112.37	124.90	132.80	137.36	136.05	136.72	136.43

IRON ORE SEABORNE INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Mar 3rd, 2023		CFR Qingdao, USD/dry tonne						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOSI62	62% Fe Fines	93.05	108.92	119.76	127.73	108.59	108.76	122.52
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	102.40	116.83	132.39	138.06	119.09	119.74	139.52

FREIGHT RATES

Mar 2nd, 2023		FREIGHT RATES - DRY BULK US$/wet tonne				
Route	Designation		Change	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
W. Australia - Qingdao	C5	7.38	-0.08	-1.01%	3.57	16.77
Tubarao - Qingdao	C3	18.12	0.30	1.67%	6.70	36.40

IRON ORE PORT LUMP INDEX MONTHLY, QUARTERLY AND YEAR-TO-DATE AVERAGES

Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023		FOT Qingdao (inc. 13% VAT), RMB/wet tonne							CFR Qingdao Equivalent (exc. 13% VAT), USD/dry tonne [1]						
Index	Fe Content	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD	November	December	January	February	MTD	QTD	YTD
IOPLI62	62.5% Fe Lump	811	922	964	988	907	907	1035	100.83	117.06	126.47	129.95	116.80	117.32	138.64

IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

Mar 3rd, 2023		PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOPI62	% Spread to IOPI62
IOPI58	58% Fe Fines	-95	-10.15%
IOPI65	65% Fe Fines	111	11.86%

Mar 3rd, 2023		SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)	
Index	Fe Content	Spread to IOSI62	% Spread to IOSI62
IOSI65	65% Fe Fines	15.15	11.84%

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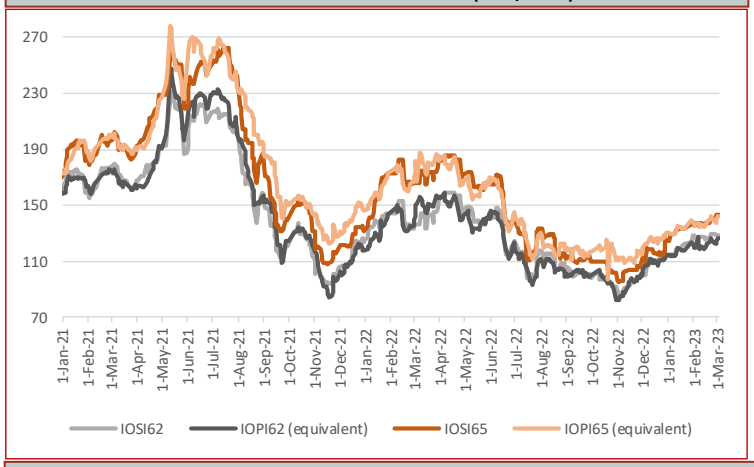
IRON ORE INDEX COMPARISONS (USD/DMT)



CHINA DOMESTIC COMPOSITE MINES INDEX (RMB/Wet Tonne, including VAT)

IRON ORE BRAND SPOT PRICE ASSESMENTS

Mar 3rd, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI62
Roy Hill	879	5	-57
SIMEC Fines	810	5	-126
PB Fines	903	5	-33
Newman Fines	905	5	-31
MAC Fines	886	5	-50
Jimblebar Blended Fines	801	5	-135
Carajas Fines	1116	4	180
Brazilian SSF	901	5	-35
Brazilian Blend Fines	917	5	-19
RTX Fines	819	5	-117
West Pilbara Fines	847	5	-89

Mar 3rd, 2023	SEABORNE INDEX (USD/DMT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOSI62
Roy Hill	123.50	-0.45	-4.50
SIMEC Fines	120.00	-0.45	-8.00
PB Fines	124.25	-0.45	-3.75
Newman Fines	127.15	-0.45	-0.85
MAC Fines	124.25	-0.45	-3.75
Jimblebar Blended Fines	116.65	-0.45	-11.35
Carajas Fines	157.55	-0.45	29.55
Brazilian SSF	131.75	-0.45	3.75
Brazilian Blend Fines	133.40	-0.45	5.40
RTX Fines	117.90	-0.45	-10.10
West Pilbara Fines	122.25	-0.45	-5.75

Mar 3rd, 2023	PORT STOCK INDEX (RMB/WT)		
	Price	Change	Diff to IOPI58
SSF	841	9	0
FMG Blended Fines	851	8	10
Robe River	852	9	11
Western Fines	855	9	14
Atlas Fines	848	8	7
Yandi	833	9	-8

IRON ORE INDEX NORMALISATION DIFFERENTIALS

Port Stock Index Product Differentials (RMB/wet tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	5.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	8.00	2.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	8.00	2.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	8.00	2.00
	Low Grade Fe	38.00	-2.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	77.00	-7.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	5.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al <2.25%	20.00	0.00
	Low Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	16.00	1.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	25.00	-1.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4-6.5%	8.00	1.00
	Low Fe Grade	48.00	-1.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	13.00	1.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	13.00	1.00
	Low Fe Grade 0.09<P<0.1%	5.00	0.00

Seaborne Index Product Differentials (USD/dry tonne)

	Applicable range	Value	Change
1% Fe	High Grade Fe 60 - 63%	3.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 63 - 64%	4.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 64 - 65%	4.00	0.00
	High Grade Fe 65 - 65.5%	4.00	0.00
1% Alumina	High Fe Grade Al <2.25%	3.50	0.00
	High Fe Grade Al 2.25-4%	3.25	0.00
1% Silica	High Fe Grade Si <4%	3.50	0.00
	High Fe Grade Si 4 - 6.5%	0.50	0.00
0.01% Phosphorus	High Fe Grade 0.09%<P<0.115%	2.75	0.00
	High Fe Grade 0.115%<P<0.15%	4.75	0.00

Port Stock Price Differentials to Qingdao Port for PB Fines (RMB/wet tonne)

Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change	Port	Value	Change
Bayuquan	-100.00	0.00	Fangcheng	-25.00	0.00	Lanshan	0.00	0.00	Rizhao	0.00	0.00
Beilun	0.00	0.00	Jiangyin	-30.00	0.00	Lianyungang	0.00	0.00	Shekou	0.00	0.00
Caofeidian	-10.00	0.00	Jingtang	-10.00	0.00	Majishan	0.00	0.00	Taicang	-30.00	0.00
Dalian	0.00	0.00	Lanqiao	0.00	0.00	Qingdao	0.00	0.00	Tianjin	0.00	0.00

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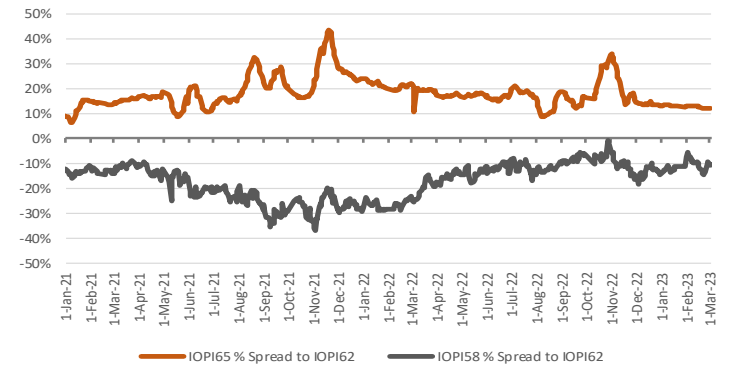
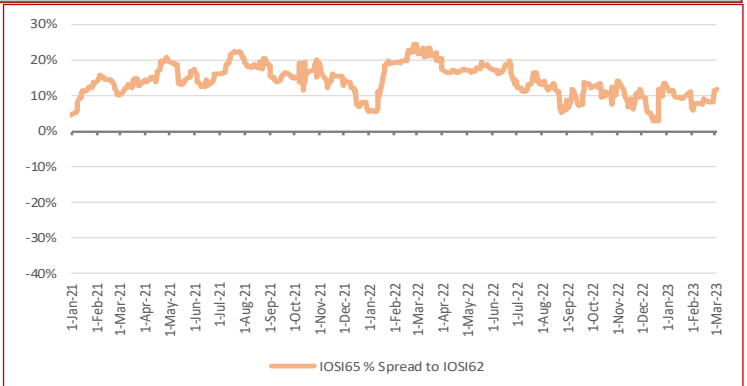
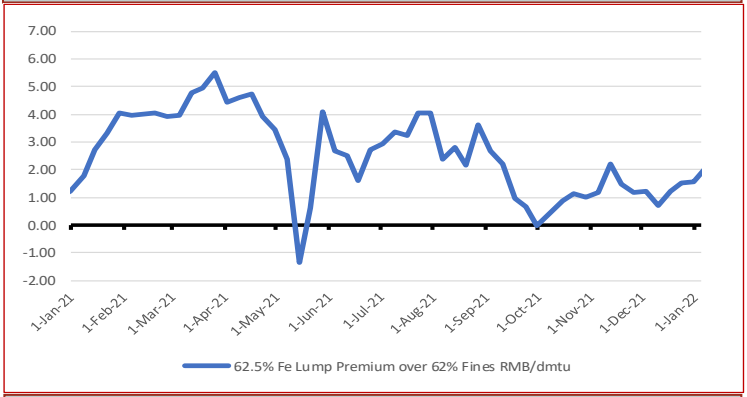
IRON ORE INDEX PREMIUMS/DISCOUNTS

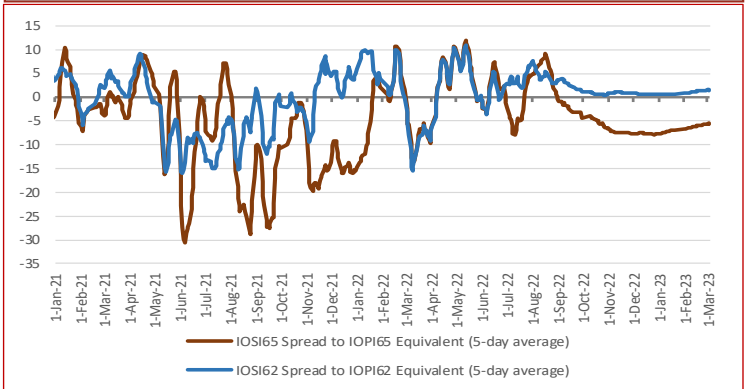




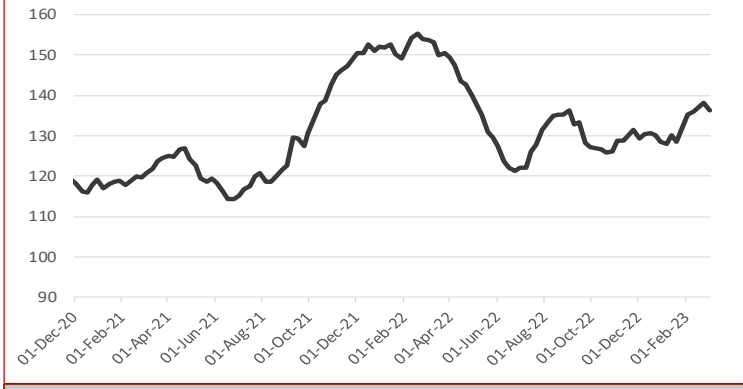
WEEKLY IRON ORE PORT STOCK LUMP PREMIUM (RMB/DMTU)



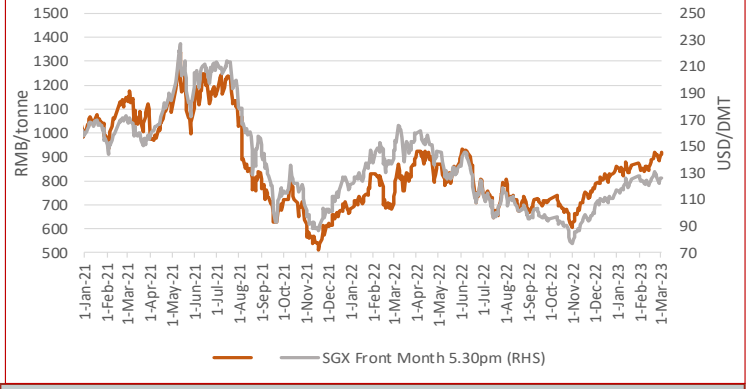
IRON ORE SEABORNE TO PORT STOCK PRICE SPREADS (USD/DMT)



TOTAL IRON ORE INVENTORIES AT CHINA PORTS (MILLION TONNES)



FUTURE TRADING—FRONT MONTH CLOSING PRICE



IRON ORE PORT INVENTORIES (MILLION TONNES)

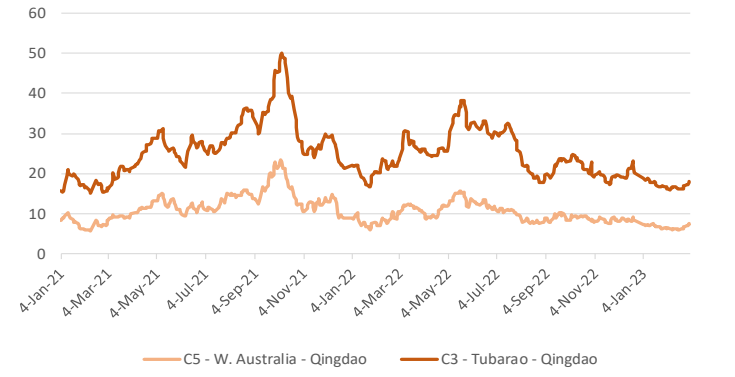
Week Ending Mar 3rd, 2023

Province	This week	Change %	Low [2]	High [2]
Jingtang	12.16	1.00%	9.84	19.20
Qingdao	25.74	-0.77%	9.41	26.24
Caofeidian	12.17	1.84%	9.05	16.29
Tianjin	12.63	4.12%	7.14	12.97
Rizhao	19.13	0.58%	9.44	19.26
Total (35 Ports)	136.26	-1.34%	98.80	155.39

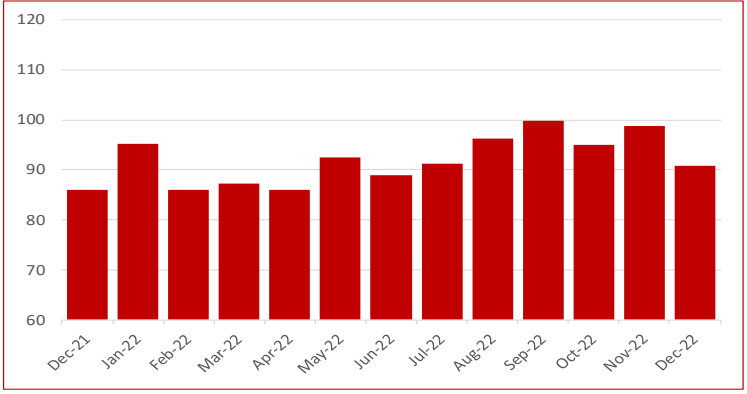
IRON ORE FUTURES CONTRACTS

	DCE (RMB/WMT)			SGX (USD/DMT)		
Closing Date	Mar 3rd, 3pm close			Mar 3rd, 5:30pm		
Contract	I2305	Change	Change %	Mar. 23	Change	Change %
Closing Price	919.00	6.50	0.71%	126.15	-0.30	-0.24%
Vol traded ('000 lots)	42.96	5.02	13.24%	1.59	-1.94	-54.99%
Open positions ('000 lots)	87.50	1.92	2.25%	25.69	-0.65	-2.45%
Day Low	910.0	5.00	0.55%	125.55	-0.50	-0.40%
Day High	923.5	9.00	0.98%	127.75	0.20	0.16%

DRY BULK FREIGHT RATES (USD/MT)



TOTAL CHINA IRON ORE IMPORT VOLUMES (MILLION TONNES)



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STEEL SPOT MARKET PRICES—CHINA

Steel Spot Market RMB/tonne

Product	2023/3/3	Change	Change %
ReBar HRB400 ϕ18mm	4,310	50	1.17%
Wirerod Q300 ϕ6.5mm	4,550	40	0.89%
HRC Q235/SS400 5.5mm*1500*C	4,340	40	0.93%
CRC SPCC/ST12 1.0mm*1250*2500	4,780	50	1.06%
Medium & Heavy Plate Q235B 20mm	4,410	40	0.92%
GI ST02Z 1.0mm*1000*C	5,020	60	1.21%
Colour Coated Plate	7,500	-50	-0.66%

CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY

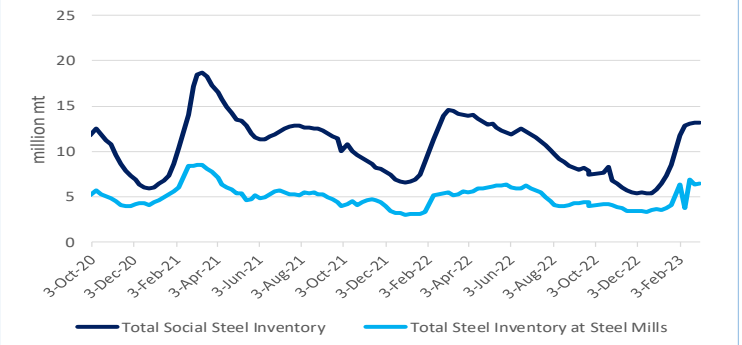
SMM Tracking of Steel Mill P&L - Rebar and Hot-rolled Coil (RMB/tonne)

Category	Price	Change (WoW)	Note
MMi (Fe 62%), USD/mt exluding tax	128.45	-1	Mmi CFR Equivalent index for 1st Feb
Coke	2,960	0	2nd grade met coke, Tangshan, incl. tax
Steel Scrap	3,200	0	steel scrap (6mm) in Zhangjiagang, exl. tax
Billet Cost	3,685	8	Q234, incl. tax
Rebar cost - Blast furnace	4,198	9	calculated based on theoretical weight, incl. tax
Rebar profit - Blast furnace	22	41	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil cost - Blast furnace	4,203	13	based on actual weight, incl. tax
Hot-rolled coil proft - Blast furnace	167	67	based on Shanghai prices, incl. tax

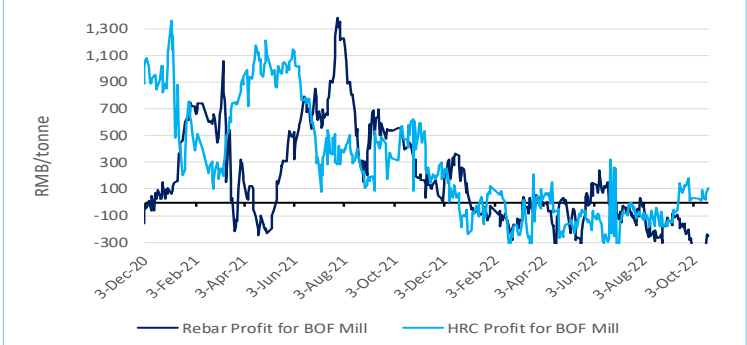
Note: 1. Costs in the table are caluclated based on todays market prices and facout our management, sales, financial and depreciations fe

2. The cost refers to average cost in the industry based on SMM's survey of small, medium and large mills in China

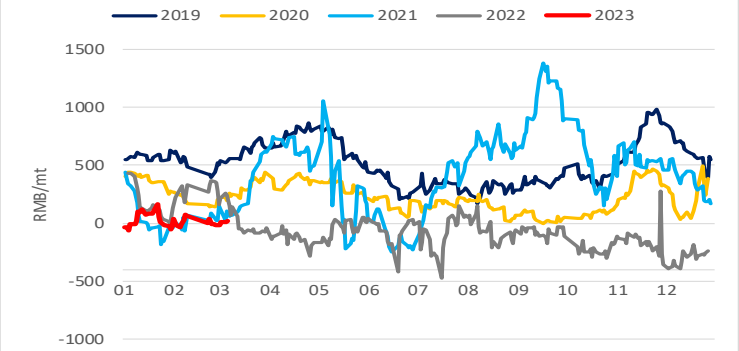
CHINESE STEEL INVENTORIES



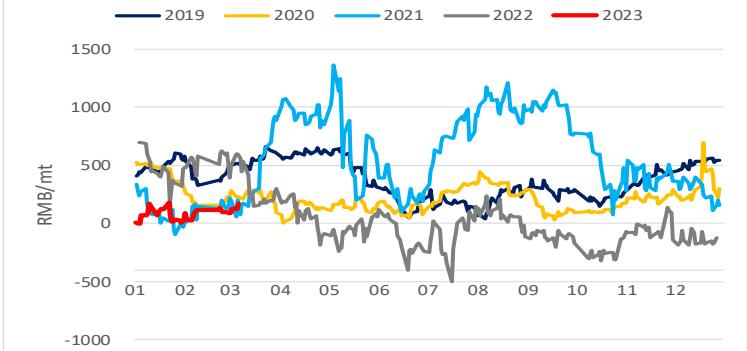
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY



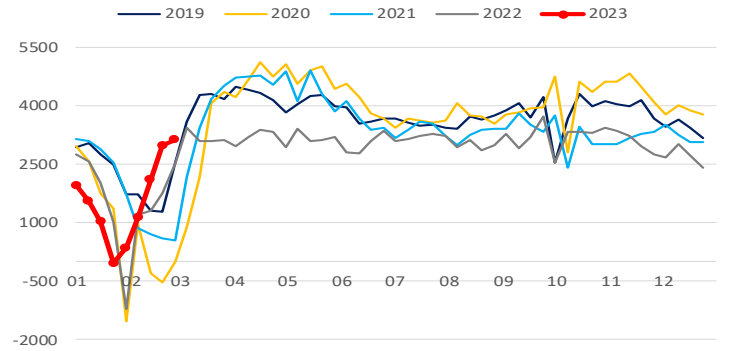
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Rebar



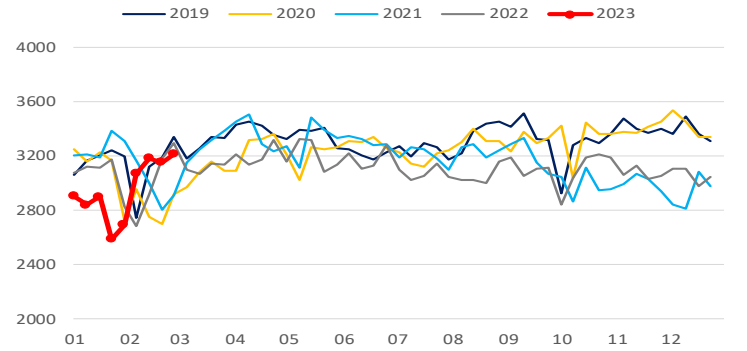
CHINESE STEEL MILL PROFITABILITY—Hot-rolled Coil



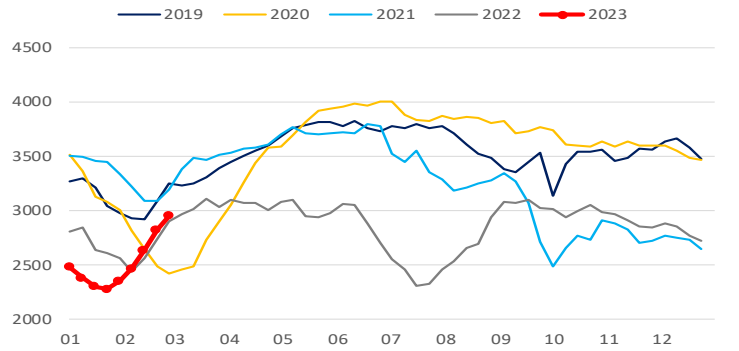
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Rebar



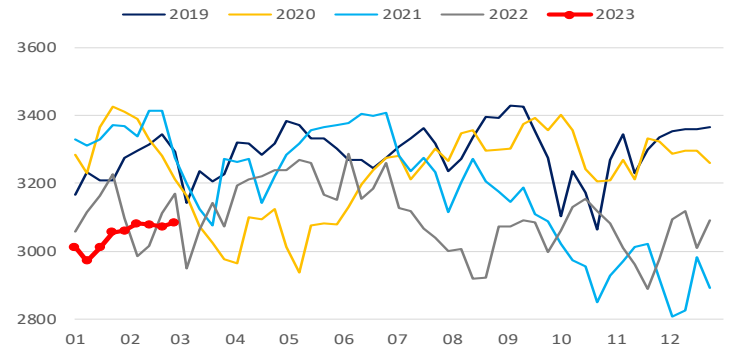
CHINESE STEEL CONSUMPTION—Hot-rolled Coil



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Rebar



CHINESE STEEL PRODUCTION—Hot-rolled Coil



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IRON ORE INDEX SPECIFICATIONS, COMPILATION RATIONALE AND DATA EXCLUSIONS

Iron Ore Index Specifications (Port and Seaborne)

	65% Fe Fines	62% Fe Fines	58% Fe Fines	62.5% Fe Lump
Fe %	65.00	62.00	58.00	62.50
Alumina %	1.40	2.25	2.25	1.50
Silica%	1.50	4.00	5.50	3.50
Phosphorus %	0.06	0.09	0.05	0.08
Sulphur %	0.01	0.02	0.02	0.02
Moisture %	8.00	8.00	9.00	4.00
Sizing	Granular size below 10mm for at least 90% of cargo; maximum of 40% below 150 micron			Size below 6.3mm max 15% Size above 31.15mm max 25%
Pricing Point	Qingdao Port (FOT and CFR respectively)			FOT Qingdao Port
Timing (Seaborne)	Loading within 4 weeks, Delivery within 8 weeks			Delivery within 2 weeks
Payment Terms	L/C at sight			L/C at sight or CAD

Iron Ore Index Compilation Rationale and Data Exclusions

MMi iron ore indices are compiled from data provided by companies that are part of the iron ore supply chain and involved in spot market transactions. The indices are calculated using detailed transaction-level data submitted to MMi by these companies. This data is normalised to the appropriate specifications and screened to remove outliers before volume-weighted average prices are calculated from the remaining core set of data.

For more details on MMi's iron ore methodology please download the guide published on our website at: www.mmiprices.com

Data Exclusions*

	62%	58%	65%
Port Index	0	0	0
Seaborne index	0		0
Lump Index 62.5	0		

* Number of price submissions for iron ore indices that were excluded from index calculations today as they were anomalous and could not be verified

IRON ORE DOMESTIC CONCENTRATE INDEX CALCULATION METHODOLOGY

The compilation method for price index generally refers to the compilation method of CPI price index and other price indices, breakdown the price data and calculate the average value according to a certain method, taking the vertical axis as the regional composite index (average of different grade index) and the horizontal axis as the grade composite index (average of different regional index), a total composite index for domestic ore can be output ultimately. The process system is also adopted in the calculation i.e. each sub-index can be obtained as well.

AVERAGE IRON ORE SPECIFICATIONS APPLIED FOR BRAND PRICE ASSESSMENTS

PORT STOCK BRANDS

Mar 3rd, 2023	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.88%	2.35%	4.45%	0.055%	9.26%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines	61.64%	2.31%	3.87%	0.099%	9.45%
Newman Fines	62.49%	2.31%	3.98%	0.090%	7.72%
MAC Fines	60.43%	2.38%	4.64%	0.078%	7.57%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.87%	2.95%	4.53%	0.111%	7.32%
Carajas Fines	64.90%	1.39%	1.82%	0.080%	7.78%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	62.56%	1.58%	4.79%	0.091%	8.72%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

Mar 3rd, 2023	Specifications applied for 58% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
SSF	56.49%	3.20%	6.19%	0.065%	9.18%
FMG Blended Fines	58.20%	2.43%	5.54%	0.057%	8.29%
Robe River	56.44%	3.16%	5.73%	0.042%	8.44%
Western Fines	57.88%	2.87%	7.50%	0.062%	7.45%
Atlas Fines	58.00%	1.85%	5.50%	0.090%	9.00%
Yandi	56.87%	1.58%	6.41%	0.042%	9.53%

SEABORNE BRANDS

	Specifications applied for 62% brand assessments				
	Fe	Alumina	Silica	Phos	Moisture
Roy Hill	60.70%	2.30%	4.90%	0.055%	8.00%
SIMEC Fines	60.00%	2.30%	6.30%	0.060%	6.00%
PB Fines 62%	62.00%	2.60%	4.30%	0.090%	9.50%
Newman Fines	62.30%	2.40%	4.30%	0.095%	8.00%
MAC Fines	60.80%	2.35%	4.40%	0.075%	7.80%
Jimblebar Blended Fines	60.50%	3.10%	4.80%	0.120%	7.80%
Carajas Fines	65.10%	1.50%	1.70%	0.080%	8.50%
Brazilian SSF	62.00%	1.00%	6.50%	0.040%	6.00%
Brazilian Blend Fines	63.00%	1.50%	5.00%	0.070%	7.00%
RTX Fines	61.00%	3.10%	4.50%	0.135%	7.50%
West Pilbara Fines	60.10%	2.30%	4.70%	0.075%	8.50%

BLOOMBERG TICKERS

PORT STOCK INDICES

	FOT Qingdao (RMB/wet tonne)	CFR Qingdao Equivalent (USD/dry tonne)
IOPI62	IRCNQ001	IRCNQ004
IOPI58	IRCNQ002	IRCNQ005
IOPI65	IRCNQ003	IRCNQ006
IOPLI62	IRCN0036	IRCN0037

SEABORNE INDICES

	CFR Qingdao (USD/DMT)
IOSI62	IRCN0034
IOSI65	IRCN0035

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